Informatica® Cloud Data Governance and Catalog

July 2026

Metadata Access Control Handbook

Informatica Cloud Data Governance and Catalog Metadata Access Control Handbook
July 2026

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Preface

Read the *Metadata Access Control Handbook* to understand how to manage metadata access at a granular level. You can also explore real-world use cases and best practices for configuring access control to metadata for the users in your organization.

CHAPTER 1

Introduction

Metadata access control in Data Governance and Catalog and Data Marketplace is the practice of managing the level of user access to assets in your catalog. You can control access through a set of privileges in Administrator and a set of rules called access policies in Metadata Command Center.

Use metadata access control to grant users access to assets based on user roles and responsibilities, providing the appropriate level of access for each user. For example, you can use metadata access control to grant a data steward permissions to create, read, update, and manage access on business asset types in the catalog. The data steward then has the access needed to perform governance tasks, while unauthorized users can't access sensitive or draft metadata.

As your data catalog rapidly evolves, metadata access control in Data Governance and Catalog and Data Marketplace helps you regulate access to assets and manage them effectively across your organization.

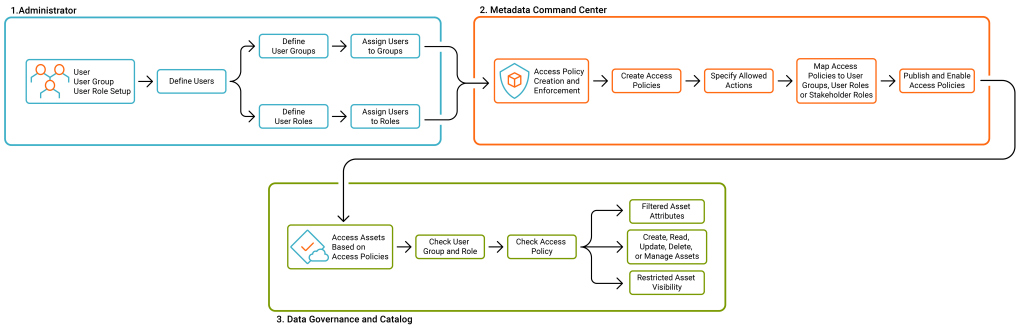
Metadata access control follows the "principle of least privilege." Under this principle, metadata access control denies all users in your organization access to all assets. Users gain access only to the minimum number of assets that they need for their requirement or role. Your organization administrator explicitly grants permissions these permissions to the user through access policies in Metadata Command Center. Because of this principle, administrators don't need to create separate policies for denying access. Access policies serve as controlled exceptions that grant users access to the metadata they can view or manage.

CHAPTER 2

How metadata access control works

To implement metadata access control in your organization, your administrator defines and assigns access policies to users to control specific assets and attributes users can view.

The following image shows how your administrator implements metadata access control in an organization and how it affects the organization:



Metadata access control uses a structured, layered approach to manage metadata access securely and efficiently. The following steps describe how metadata access control works:

1. In Administrator, the administrator defines users, user groups, and user roles. The administrator then assigns the users to user groups and user roles to determine the level of access and permission that each user has. This assignment forms the foundation of metadata access control.
2. In Metadata Command Center, the administrator creates and enforces access policies and creates stakeholder roles from user roles. The administrator can then use these stakeholder roles within access policies to grant users granular access to assets. Access policies specify which user groups, user roles, or stakeholder roles can access specific assets and what actions they can perform on the assets.
3. In Data Governance and Catalog, users can see only the assets or attributes that the access policies for their user group, user role, or stakeholder role allow them to view. Those same access policies determine the actions that users can perform on assets, such as create, update, delete, and manage.

CHAPTER 3

Uses of metadata access control

Data governance and Data Marketplace experts can use metadata access control in many ways to ensure that users in their organization can access only authorized metadata assets and attributes. Use metadata access control for secure collaboration and to manage metadata efficiently across diverse organizational units and data domains.

The following table describes how you can manage access for the different types of assets and asset attributes:

Assets and asset attributes	How metadata access control helps
High-level asset types	Control access to broad categories of assets such as business, technical, or marketplace assets. For example, grant all permissions on all Data Marketplace assets to Data Marketplace Administrators.
Individual asset types	Manage permissions on specific asset types such as business terms, catalog sources, or data collections. For example, business users might have read access to only business terms.
Attribute groups	Use attribute groups to control access to specific asset attributes such as basic and advanced profiling statistics or code definitions. For example, use attribute groups to limit access to unpublished or draft changes for glossary stewards only, thereby protecting sensitive information during updates.
Asset groups	Use asset groups to control access to specific sets of assets or entire hierarchies based on parameters like user's location, business area, or function within the organization. For example, create asset groups for different business units and assign assets accordingly. Then, use access policies to grant appropriate read or manage permissions to users within those business units.
Attribute value	Control access to assets based on the values of their attributes such as asset lifecycle status, category status, or data collection status. For example, only authorized users can see assets that are in the draft status.

Additionally, you can grant general asset permissions through user roles and allow extended or restricted permissions to users based on their responsibilities as asset stakeholders.

CHAPTER 4

Key concepts

To understand how your administrators can manage access to assets using metadata access control, you need a basic understanding of the following key concepts.

Roles and groups

As an organization administrator, the first step to using metadata access control is to create the objects that define the access levels your organization needs. This includes users, user groups, and user roles in Administrator, as well as stakeholder roles in Metadata Command Center.

User

A user is an individual Intelligent Data Management Cloud account that can perform tasks and access assets based on the roles that you assign to the user. You can create user accounts for your organization in Administrator. You can assign roles directly to the user or to a group that the user is a member of.

User group

A user group is a group of users who can perform tasks and access assets based on the roles that you assign to the group. In Administrator, you can create user groups for your organization.

Role

A role is a set of privileges that you can assign to users and user groups. When you create roles and assign the appropriate permissions and privileges, these roles establish the boundaries within which users can act.

With metadata access control, you can use the following types of roles to grant users various levels of access:

- "User roles" on page 9
- "Stakeholder roles" on page 10

User roles

A user role defines the permissions and privileges for various types of assets and features. In Administrator, organization administrators can create user roles and assign them to the users or user groups within their organization.

The user roles that the administrator creates for your organization appear on the **Users** tab on the **Access Control** page in Metadata Command Center. You can use the user roles in access policies to grant users access and permissions for various types of assets.

For more information about creating user roles and assigning them to users and user groups, see *User Administration* in Administrator.

Stakeholder roles

A stakeholder role is a defined organizational responsibility that you declare on assets.

In contrast to user roles, which determine the permissions and privileges assigned to users or user groups within a service, stakeholder roles control how authorized users interact with the assets for which they are responsible. These roles reflect a user's responsibilities as a stakeholder of an asset and grant only the permissions and privileges needed to perform governance tasks on that asset.

For example, you can use the Category Owner stakeholder role to manage the data within a Data Marketplace category and control access to that data. In an organization, the administrator assigns the Category Owner stakeholder role to a finance controller for the Finance category and the same role to the payroll coordinator for the HR category. Although they share the same role, neither stakeholder has control over the other's category. The finance controller can't access the HR category as a stakeholder, and the payroll coordinator can't access the Finance category.

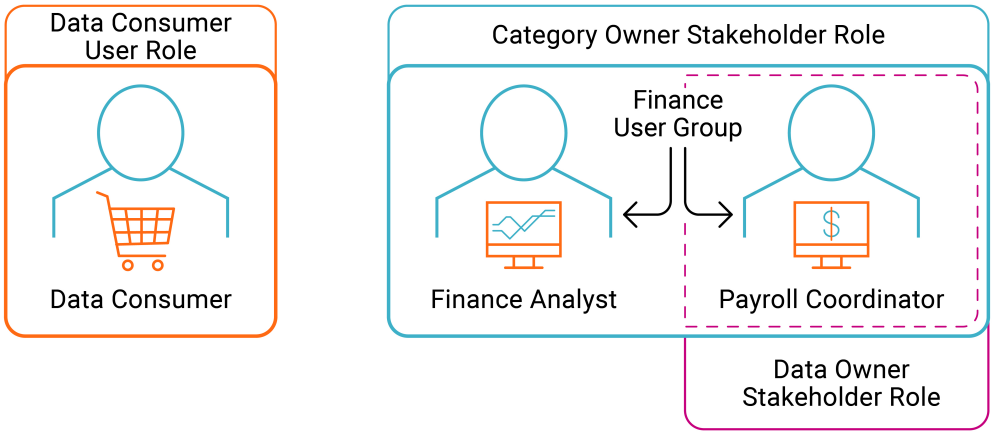
In Metadata Command Center, you can create stakeholder roles from user roles and use them in access policies to grant users granular access to assets. If you assign a stakeholder to an asset, the stakeholder role policies that you configure with the non-stakeholder option determine the level of access and permissions for users who aren't stakeholders of the asset.

Note: You can't delete a stakeholder role that you create. In Administrator, if you delete the user role that corresponds to the stakeholder role, a warning icon appears next to the stakeholder role in Metadata Command Center, and you need to disable the stakeholder role.

Relationship between roles and groups

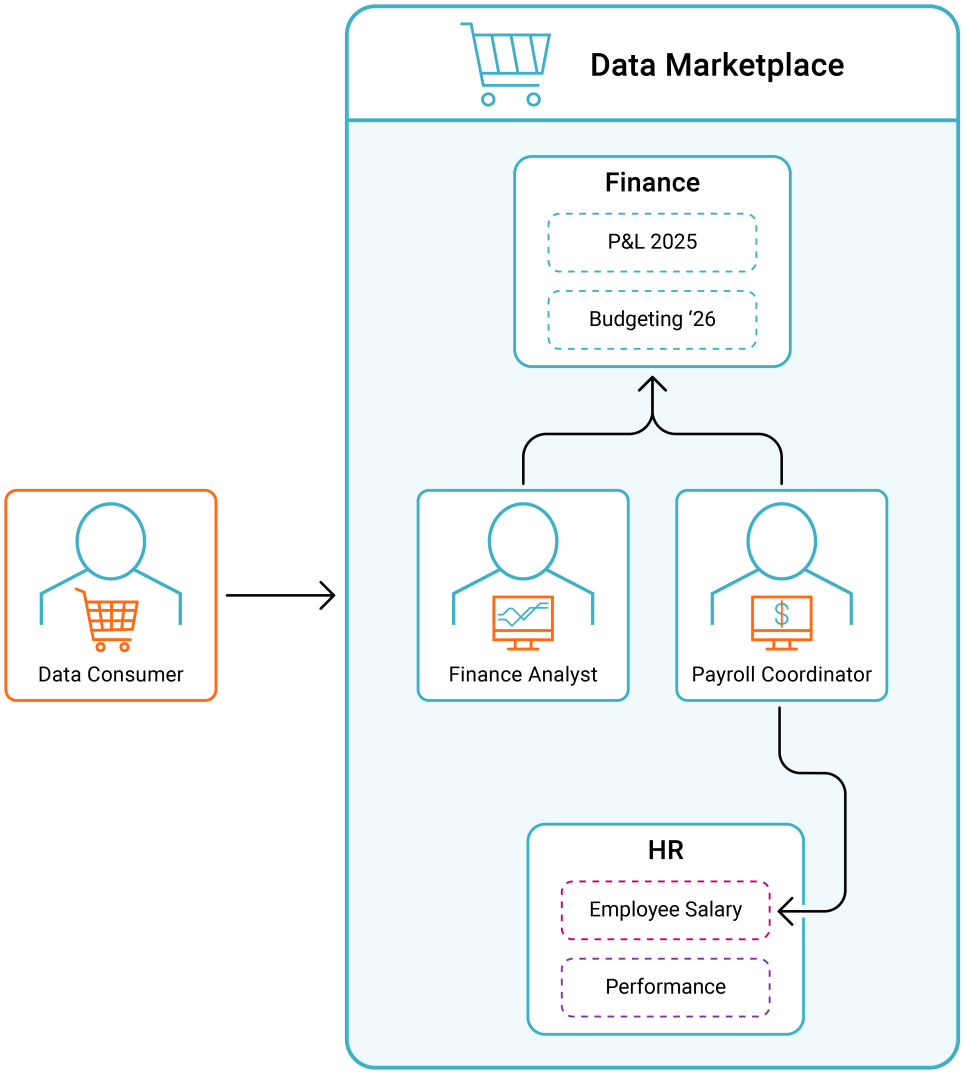
A user's access to assets depends on the roles assigned to them, the user groups they belong to, and the roles assigned to those user groups.

The following image shows the relationship between users, user groups, user roles, and stakeholder roles:



The Data Consumer user has the Data Consumer user role. The Finance Analyst and Payroll Coordinator users are part of the Finance user group, which has the Category Owner stakeholder role. The Payroll Coordinator user also has the Data Owner stakeholder role.

The following image shows the different access levels that are available to user roles and stakeholder roles:



In the image, the Data Consumer, Finance Analyst, and Payroll Coordinator users have the following permissions on the Finance and HR categories in Data Marketplace:

- The Data Consumer user has access to Data Marketplace granted through the Data Consumer user role. However, the user doesn't have access to manage the categories in Data Marketplace.
- The administrator assigns the Finance Analyst and Payroll Coordinator users as stakeholders on the Finance category. They receive this access through the Category Owner stakeholder role that the administrator assigns to the Finance user group. Both users can manage the category and the data collections within it.
- The administrator also assigns the Payroll Coordinator user as a stakeholder on the Employee Salary data collection within the HR category. The Data Owner stakeholder role grants this access to the user. With this role, the Payroll Coordinator user can manage the Employee Salary data collection within the HR category but doesn't have permissions for the HR category.

Access policies

Use access policies to control access to the assets and application functionalities available to each user. Each access policy grants a user the level of access they need. Access policies rely on roles and permissions to authorize each user.

In a role-based access control system, your organization administrator assigns one or more roles to each user or user group. Each role maps to a set of permissions or privileges for certain actions. In large enterprises, it isn't practical to create a separate role for each permission combination.

With metadata access control, access depends not only on a user's role but also on other attributes, giving you fine-grained access control. Use policy-based access control to simplify access management and keep assets secure.

Example

For example, you are a systems architect at a financial institution. You set up access for a security analyst who works from multiple locations. The analyst's role grants access to the assets in the databases at facilities A, B, and C. The analyst needs to respond to a critical security incident at facility E and assess potential data breaches. Their role doesn't grant access to the databases at facility E. In a role-based access control system, you would need to create a new role for the analyst. However, with metadata access control, you can create a policy that grants the analyst the permissions they need to access the data in facility E.

Metadata access control uses a set of rules to define permissions and control the level of access to organizational assets. The set of rules constitutes an access policy.

To define an access policy, you can create rules that define the following conditions:

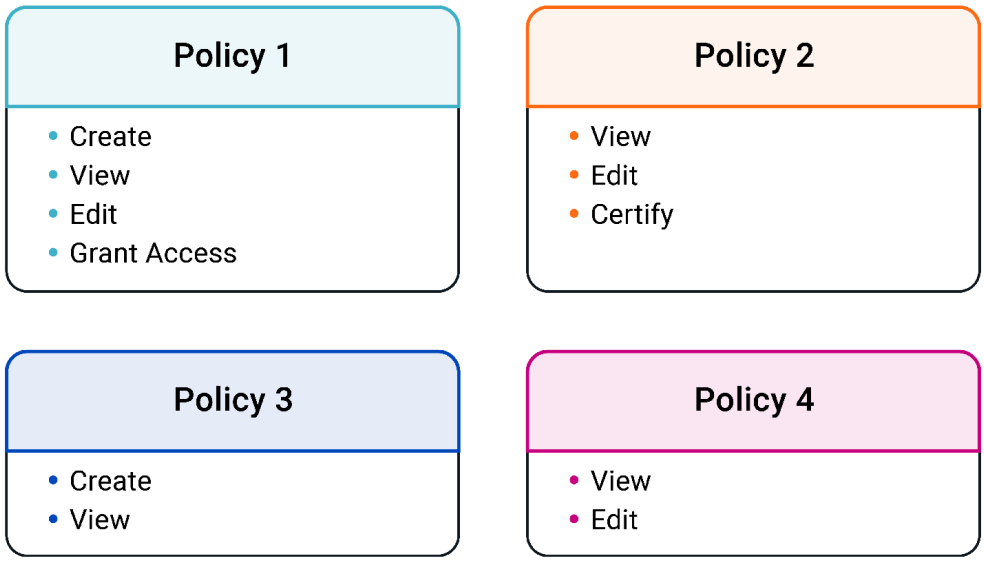
- Subject. Who is the user, and what is their identity and function?
- Object. What is the user trying to access?
- Operation. Is the user attempting to view, modify, delete, or transfer information?

How access policies work

Access policies control which assets or attributes a user can access. Because metadata access control denies access by default, a user gains access only through the access policies that your administrator publishes and enables. A published policy doesn't grant access until you enable it.

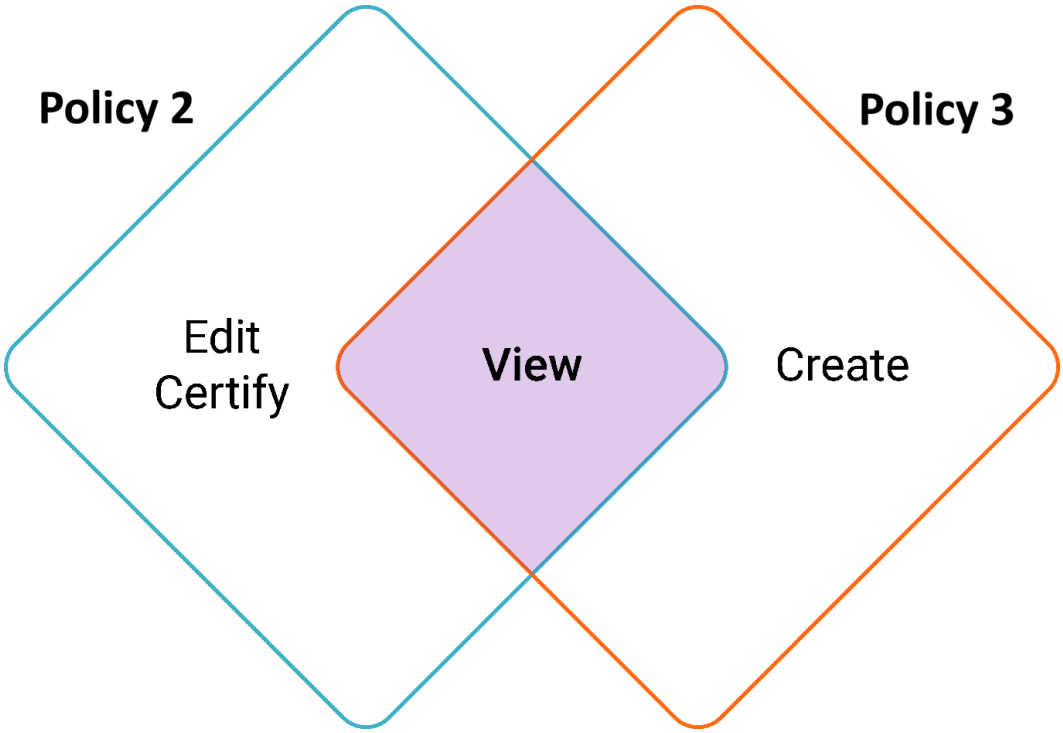
The policies that apply to a user determine their effective permissions. If you have multiple access policies that grant a user access to assets, the effective permission is the intersection of permissions from all the policies. A user gets a permission only if every policy, applied together, grants the user that permission. This intersection is the most restrictive model, where only the permissions shared by all policies take effect. When you design new access policies, review the existing policies for conflicting rules.

The following image shows four policies that grant different permissions to access organizational resources:



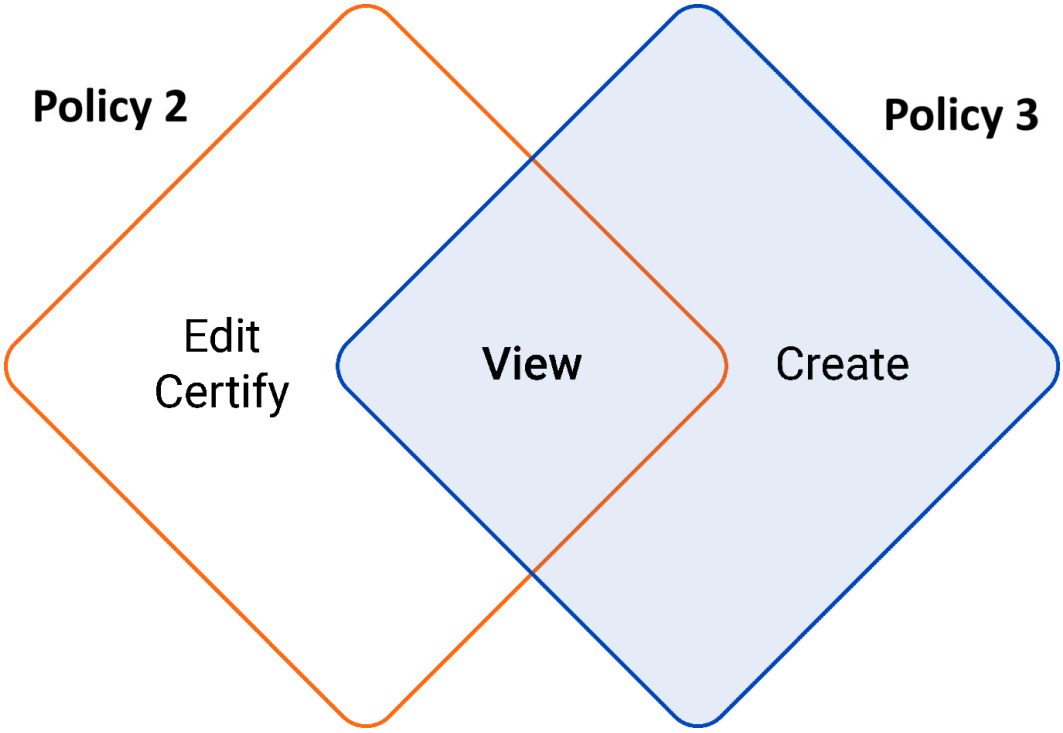
Policy 1 grants the administrator permissions to grant access to other users or groups. As an example, for a Glossary Steward, the administrator might grant a combination of Policy 2 and Policy 3.

The following image shows the intersection between the two policies:



Each circle represents the set of permissions granted by an individual access policy. The central, overlapping area shows the resulting permissions that the user actually gets. In this case, the Glossary Steward gets only the View permission. However, the administrator can configure Policy 3 to override other policy types. In this case, the effective permissions are View and Create.

The following image shows the effective permissions when Policy 3 overrides other policy types:



Types of access policies

In Metadata Command Center, you can create multiple types of access policies. Each policy applies to a different level of access control.

You create access policies from a set of rules in Metadata Command Center to define permissions and control the level of access to the assets in your organization.

Access policy	Description
User role policy	Defines the access level for users to whom you assign a user role in Administrator.
Stakeholder role policy	Defines the access level for users to whom you assign a stakeholder role on assets.
User group policy	Defines the access level for users whom you add to a user group in Administrator. You can also use this access policy to control the access level of all users in the organization.

User role policy

User role policies control access to assets based on the role of the user in the organization.

For example, a Human Resources benefits analyst in India can have access policies that grant them Read and Update permissions on all data assets in the India Employees database through a user role policy.

Stakeholder role policy

Stakeholder role policies control access levels of users who are stakeholders on certain asset types. These policies give stakeholders granular control over assets that the user role would otherwise restrict.

Before you create a stakeholder role policy, create a stakeholder role, map it to a user role, and associate asset types. You can select a combination of technical assets, business assets, Data Marketplace assets, and Data Access Management assets.

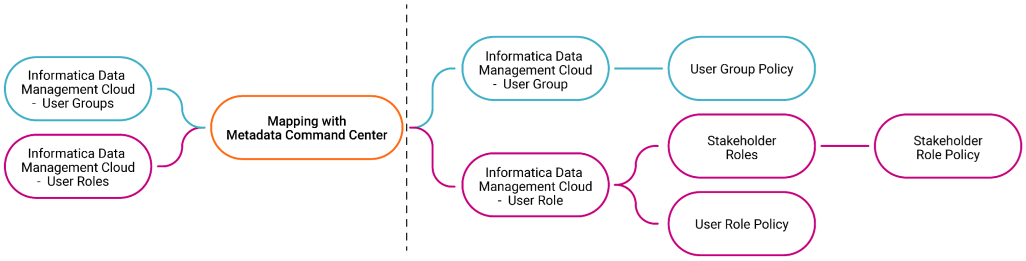
You can also create stakeholder role policies that apply to all users who don't have stakeholder roles. These policies can grant edit or approval rights at the domain or asset level. For example, a Data Steward can delegate stewardship to a Glossary Steward over specific collections or glossaries without changing their user role.

User group policy

User group policies control access to resources based on the user group that the user belongs to.

You can also create user group policies that apply to all users in the organization. These policies let you grant access to an entire department on certain project assets. For example, you can create user group policies to facilitate a smooth onboarding process for contractors.

The following image shows how user roles and user groups form the various policy types:



Predefined and custom access policies

In Metadata Command Center, administrators can use predefined policies or define custom policies specific to their organization. Predefined policies apply to the predefined user roles that you define in Administrator.

Metadata Command Center provides predefined access policies that cover many access control situations in an organization. For a list of predefined access policies, see Predefined Access Policies.

Among the predefined access policies available, you can also find access policies that grant access to users who aren't stakeholders on specific asset types. The No Asset Group access policy grants all permissions to users on assets that don't belong to asset groups. You can further restrict access with custom access policies.

Instead of creating a completely new access policy, you can adapt the predefined access policies to suit your use case. To modify a predefined access policy, clone the access policy and change the parameters based on your access control requirements.

Example

For example, you are a data scientist in a large manufacturing firm that produces sealing containers for the food processing industry. Your task is to perform a case study that identifies the root cause of the rising number of defective goods that Unit A produces. For each batch of products, you have access to data sampled by quality control inspectors. This data includes the component dimensions.

You need to run data profiling to retrieve the column statistics that the analytical models require for the case study. To run data profiles, you require the Create, Read, Update, Delete, and Execute permissions on the Profiling attribute group. Also, to view value frequencies for data elements after you run a data profile, you require the Read permission on the Data attribute group.

To achieve the required level of access to perform these tasks, the administrator needs to perform the following steps:

1. Clone the Governance User user role policy and select the user role.
   The default rules provide only Read permission on the Profiling attribute group.
2. Edit the rules to include Create, Read, Update, Delete, and Execute permissions.
3. Create a new rule to provide Read permission on the Data attribute group.
4. Save the access policy.
5. Publish and enable the access policy so that it takes effect for the user role.

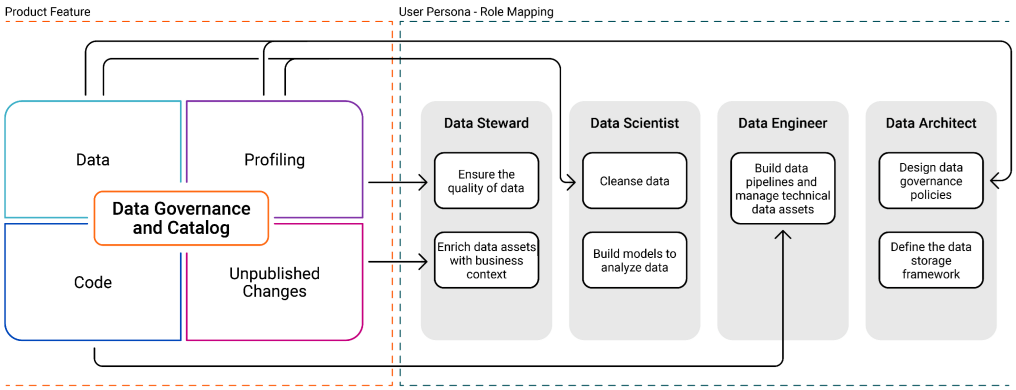
Attribute groups

Use attribute groups to control access to asset attributes when you define access policies. Attribute groups can also control usage of features.

The following table describes the attribute groups that you can use:

Attribute Group	Description
Profiling	Attributes related to basic data profiling results.
Data	Attributes related to advanced data profiling results such as value frequency and minimum and maximum values.
Code	Attributes related to the programmatic definition of an asset that you can view on the **Code** tab for technical assets.
Unpublished changes	Attribute values related to assets that are pending review in an approval workflow process.

The following image shows the relationships between the user roles for each user persona and the product features controlled by attribute groups:



- Data Steward. The primary focus of this role is data quality, metadata management, and enrichment with business context. Data stewards use profiling to assess quality, and data scientists use it to understand data structure before modeling. Users with the data steward role create, edit, and approve metadata enrichments before publishing them.

- Data Scientist. Data scientists cleanse data for specific needs and build data models.
- Data Engineer. The primary domain of a data engineer is to build the pipelines and manage the physical data assets.
- Data Architect. Data architects work at a structural level to design policies and frameworks. They define the high-level governance policies that the system enforces.

Asset groups

Use asset groups to control access to a set of assets or entire asset hierarchies. When administrators organize assets into groups, they can apply user group policies that grant or restrict access to multiple assets at once.

You can create asset groups in Metadata Command Center from the **Customize** > **Asset Groups** page or from the **New** > **Customization** > **Asset Group** page. To assign asset groups to assets, the users in your organization require the appropriate permissions granted through access policies in Metadata Command Center.

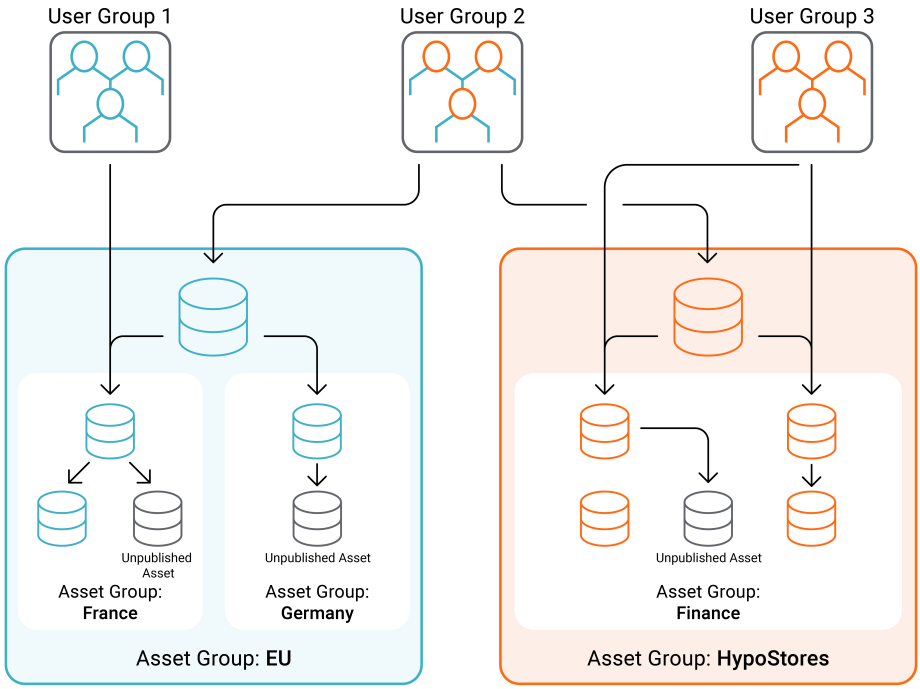
Example

For example, the administrator of a global retail store chain, HypoStores, defines the following asset groups in Metadata Command Center:

- **EU**, which represents the European region. The EU asset group contains two child asset groups to denote two regions within Europe, **France** and **Germany**.
- **HypoStores**, which represents the organization. The **HypoStores** asset group contains the child asset group **Finance** to denote the business department within the organization.

The data steward then assigns the asset groups to the respective assets in Data Governance and Catalog, while the administrator grants various access permissions to the three different user groups through access policies in Metadata Command Center.

The following image shows how various user groups interact with the assets within the asset groups based on the permissions that you grant:



In this image, User Group 1 has access to assets only within the "France" asset group and its hierarchy. User Group 2 has access to all assets in the parent asset groups, "EU" and "HypoStores". User Group 3 has access to assets only within the "Finance" asset group. The users with the Data Steward role can view the unpublished asset changes in all asset groups.

Asset group hierarchy

You can organize asset groups in any hierarchical structure that aligns with your business use case. Use the hierarchical structure to model your access control in a way that reflects your business units, geographic locations, or functional areas.

When you create asset groups, design the hierarchy carefully. The hierarchy directly influences how access policies control user access to assets. Consider the following guidelines when you create an asset group hierarchy:

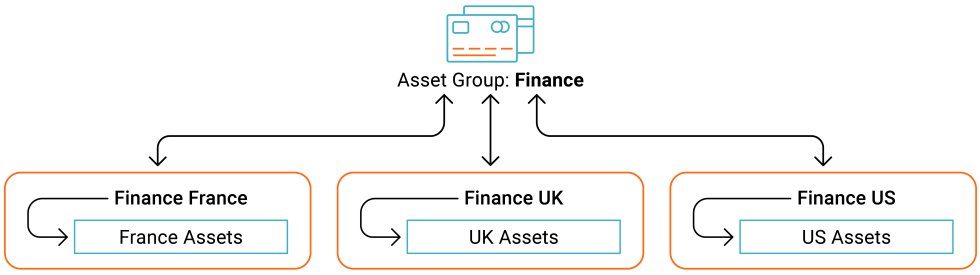
- You can form parent-child relationships between asset groups.
- An asset group hierarchy can have a maximum of four levels of nesting. A parent asset group can have up to three levels of child asset groups.
- If a user has permissions on a parent asset group, the permissions propagate down to its child asset groups. Access policies applied at the parent level affect all assets within the child asset groups.
- If a user has permissions on a child asset group, the user inherently gains permissions on the parent asset group as well.

You can structure asset group hierarchies in many ways. The structure of your asset group depends on your business use case.

Example

For example, the administrator of a multinational company created various asset group hierarchies for grouping assets based on business units and geographic regions. The following examples show how access policies at various levels of the hierarchy affect the visibility of assets:

- The following image shows an example asset group hierarchy that the company uses to organize its finance function across the three geographical regions of France, UK, and US:



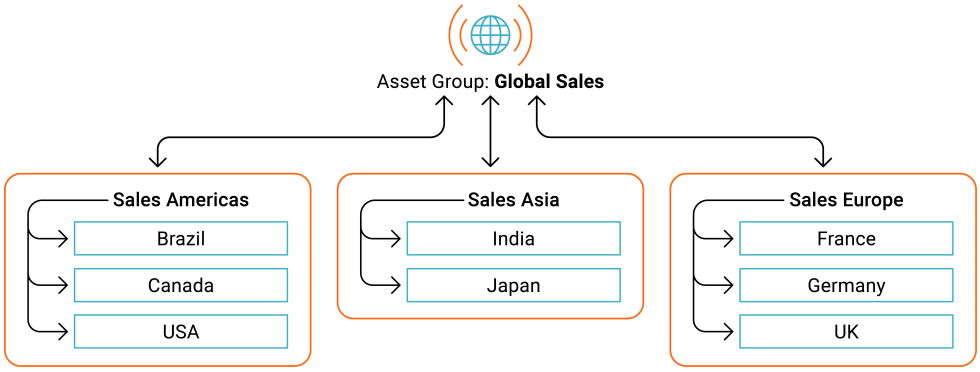
  Users with access to the "Finance" asset group can access the following assets:

  - All assets in the "Finance" asset group
  - All assets in the child asset groups "Finance France", "Finance UK", and "Finance US"

  Users with access to the "Finance US" asset group can access the following assets:

  - All assets in the "Finance US" asset group
  - All assets within the "Finance" asset group
  - No assets in the peer asset groups "Finance France" and "Finance UK"

- The following image shows an example asset group hierarchy that the company has used to organize its sales assets across Europe, Asia, and America:



  Users with access to the "Sales Europe" asset group can access the following assets:

  - All assets within the "Sales Europe" asset group
  - All assets within the child asset groups "Sales France", "Sales Germany", and "Sales UK"
  - All assets in the "Global Sales" parent asset group
  - No assets in the peer asset groups "Sales Americas" and "Sales Asia"

Best practices for using asset groups

Consider the following best practices to use asset groups effectively:

- Follow a "less is more" approach and keep the number of asset groups minimal to enhance efficiency and manageability.
- Arrange asset groups in a hierarchical structure that suits your organizational needs. Asset group hierarchy impacts how access policies propagate and affect user access to assets.
- Define access policies to benefit users at various levels of the asset group hierarchy. Access policies that you define and apply at various levels of the asset group hierarchy impact the visibility of assets.
- Limit nesting of asset groups to four levels. This limit helps maintain a manageable asset group structure.
- Place the most restricted assets in child asset groups to enforce tighter access control. To apply proper access restrictions, combine this approach with precise and correctly scoped access control policies. Avoid granting overly broad permissions at higher levels in the hierarchy if sensitive assets exist in child groups. Instead, tailor access policies at each level to grant access strictly on a need-to-know basis.

CHAPTER 5

Best practice recommendations

To effectively apply metadata access control in your organization, define business processes that manage roles and permissions. Ensure that these processes align with your organization's governance objectives.

Consider the following best practices when you use metadata access control for your organization:

- **Minimize access policies**. When you begin, follow a "less is more" approach and start by creating only a few access policies. This approach simplifies debugging and helps you manage and troubleshoot access issues more easily. After you implement the initial access policies in your organization, you can create additional policies.
- **Establish administration guidelines at the platform level**. Define clear guidelines to manage who can modify settings that affect the entire Intelligent Data Management Cloud platform.
- **Identify experts to define service-level roles**. For specific services in the Intelligent Data Management Cloud platform, identify users for each service who have expert knowledge of the required permissions and privileges. These users can help you define the appropriate roles.
- **Coordinate across role experts**. Verify that the experts who assist in defining roles for each service collaborate closely with each other. This coordination helps prevent conflicts, overlaps, or gaps in permissions, supporting effective and secure access management.
- **Define a process to create roles**. Establish a formal process for the creation of roles. The process can include defining naming conventions and identifying role requirements before you create a role. A clear process maintains clarity and minimizes redundancy and overlap among roles. You can also define additional guidelines to address the needs unique to your organization.
- **Enable the access policies you create**. When you create an access policy, publish the policy before you enable it.
- **Document each role clearly**. Document each role clearly to maintain transparency and consistency in how permissions are assigned and managed across the organization. This documentation can include the permissions and privileges assigned to the role, the associated access policies, and the departments eligible for the role.
- **Conduct regular reviews**. Regularly review roles to verify that their access levels remain accurate. These reviews help you identify users who no longer need certain roles, eliminate redundant roles, and find where new roles are needed for evolving organizational requirements. Additionally, reviews support security and compliance efforts and assist with external audits.

CHAPTER 6

Example: Protect personally identifiable information

You work at SuperCars, a multinational car leasing company with operations across many locations in North America. Your organization holds operational data from a large number of customers worldwide. You are a data steward, and your assigned user role gives you unrestricted access to all data sets in your assigned region.

Problem statement

The compliance department requests sample customer data that resides in multiple source systems for a critical audit. Your job is to prepare the data for a compliance audit.

The primary requirement is that the data sets have a quality score with at least 95 percent accuracy. However, providing direct access might expose sensitive personally identifiable information such as SSNs and credit scores, which violates privacy regulations. Manually creating a sanitized version of the data is slow and error-prone, and it delays essential compliance checks.

Solution

SuperCars can create user role policies that grant access to users in the compliance department while restricting access to columns that contain sensitive data. This granular access gives each role only the permissions it needs.

Solution summary

SuperCars can use metadata access control to grant the right set of permissions over the required data sets to the compliance team. To do so, perform the following steps:

1. In Administrator, create a custom role named Compliance Auditor from the predefined Governance Owner user role. After you create the role, you can assign the role to members of the compliance department who need access to the data.
2. In Metadata Command Center, create a custom access policy from the predefined Governance Owner user role policy to control access to sensitive data for all users assigned to this role. The predefined Governance Owner user role policy grants permissions to users to work with technical assets in their organization.

Creating a user role in Administrator

As an organization administrator, create a custom role named Compliance Auditor from the predefined Governance Owner user role in Administrator, and assign the role to members of the compliance department who need access to the data.

1. In Administrator, select **User Roles**.
2. In the **User Roles** grid, click the Action menu icon next to the Governance Owner role, and then click **Clone**.
3. Update the name of the new role to `Compliance Auditor`.
4. Click **Save**.

On the **Users** tab, you can assign the Compliance Auditor user role to users from the compliance team. For more information about how you can assign a role to a user, see *User Administration* in the Administrator help.

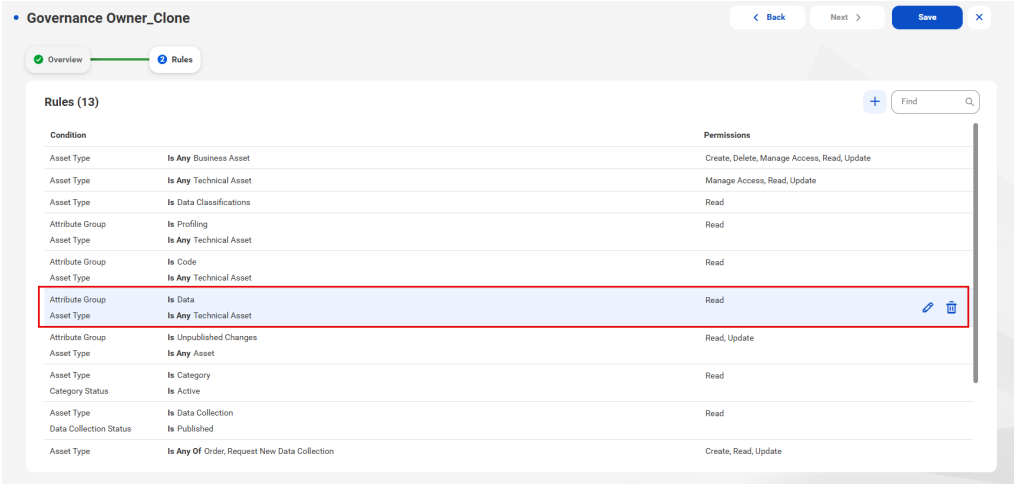
Creating a user role policy in Metadata Command Center

In Metadata Command Center, create a custom access policy from the predefined Governance Owner user role policy to control access to sensitive data for all users assigned to this role.

1. In Metadata Command Center, open the **Access Control** page.
2. On the **Access Control** page, click the **Access Policies** tab.
3. Click the Action menu icon next to the Governance Owner access policy, and then click **Clone**.
4. Enter a name and description for the new policy.
5. In the **User Role** field, select the Compliance Auditor user role.
6. Click **Next** to go to the **Rules** tab.

   Note that the rule on the Profiling attribute group grants access to create and run data profiling on technical assets.
7. Delete the rule on the Data attribute group.

   You can use the Data attribute group to view value frequencies after you run a data profile. When you remove the rule from the access policy, users governed by the policy can no longer see column values.



8. Click **Save**.
9. Publish and enable the access policy.

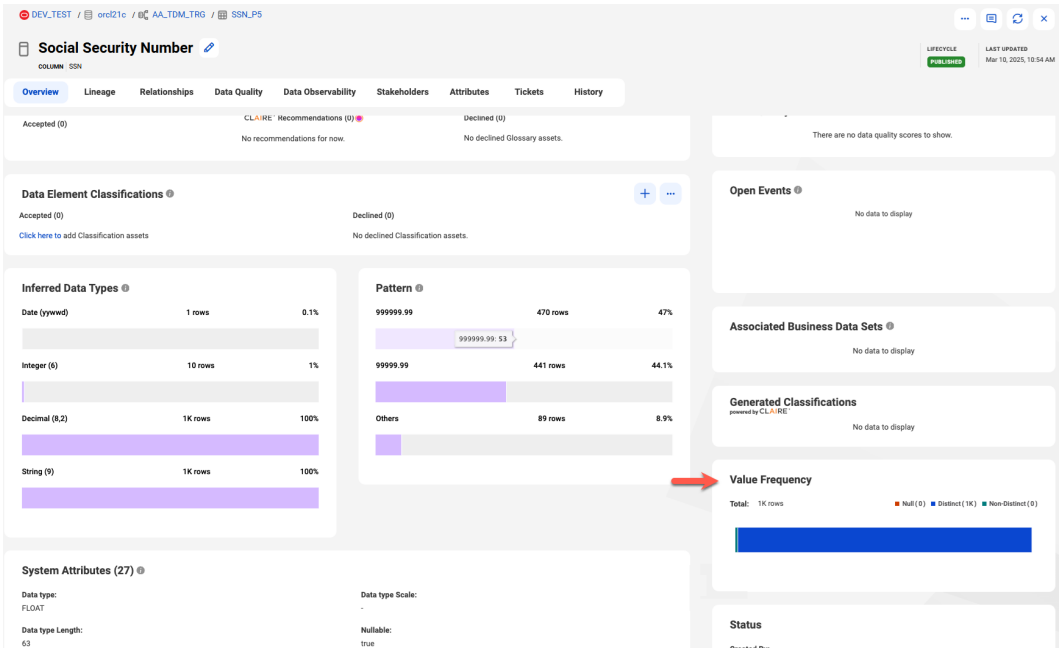
Result

After the access policy takes effect, you can verify that it restricts access to sensitive information or metadata.

To verify that the access policy restricts access to sensitive information or metadata, perform the following steps:

1. Log in to Data Governance and Catalog as a user with the Compliance Auditor role.
2. Search for `SSN`, `Social Security Number`, or `Date of Birth` and click the column from the search results.

On the asset overview page, you can see that the value frequencies no longer appear because the access policy restricts the user's access to those assets. This result confirms that the access policy is effective for all users with the Compliance Auditor role.



CHAPTER 7

Example: Restrict access to draft business assets

Infracom Enterprises manages critical infrastructure and utilities across multiple regions, where over 2,500 employees access metadata assets daily. Increasing regulatory compliance requirements have raised significant concerns about data security. The organization is implementing enhanced security measures for its cloud-based data governance and catalog platform.

Problem statement

Infracom Enterprises uses a centralized data catalog that contains business glossaries, technical metadata, data lineage information, and data quality rules across 15 different business units.

Following a recent internal audit, the organization has mandated a comprehensive review of access permissions to ensure proper segregation of metadata access while maintaining operational efficiency. Restricting access to a designated set of users while denying access to all other employees is a challenging task.

Solution

The organization has identified the Technical Owner and Business User personas to enforce segregation of duties, roles, and responsibilities. As an administrator, you create user roles that correspond to these

personas. You then create user role policies and stakeholder role policies to give each persona only the permissions it needs.

Solution summary

Infracom can use metadata access control to grant the right set of permissions over the required assets. To do so, perform the following steps:

1. In Administrator, create the following custom roles:
   - **Technical Owner role**. The role includes users such as data engineers, database administrators, and ETL developers. Users with the Technical Owner role require the necessary permissions to manage metadata extracted from various source systems. They require access to create, update, and delete technical assets such as schemas, tables, columns, and databases.

     Users with the Technical Owner role require read-only access to business assets. These assets include published business glossary terms, data quality rules, and the data classifications that you use to curate technical assets. These users can't access business assets in the draft state.
   - **Business User role**. Assign read-only access to published business assets for all employees with the Business User role.

   After you create the roles, assign the roles to the appropriate personnel.
2. In Metadata Command Center, create a stakeholder role based on the Technical Owner user role and a stakeholder role policy for the new stakeholder role. Then, create user role policies for the Technical Owner and Business User user roles.

Creating user roles in Administrator

As an organization administrator, create custom roles named Technical Owner and Business User in Administrator, and assign the roles to your employees.

1. In Administrator, select **User Roles**.
2. In the **User Roles** grid, click the Action menu icon next to the Governance Owner role, and then click **Clone**.
3. Update the name of the cloned role to `Technical Owner`.
4. Click **Save**.
5. In the **User Roles** grid, click the Action menu icon next to the Governance User role, and then click **Clone**.
6. Update the name of the new role to `Business User`.
7. Click **Save**.

On the **Users** tab, you can assign the new user roles to the users in your organization. For more information about how you can assign a role to a user, see *User Administration* in the Administrator help.

Creating a stakeholder role in Metadata Command Center

In Metadata Command Center, create a stakeholder role from the Technical Owner user role.

1. In Metadata Command Center, open the **Access Control** page.
2. On the **Access Control** page, click the **Users** tab.
3. Click the **Stakeholder Roles** tab, and then click **Add**.
4. In the **User Role** field, select the **Technical Owner** user role.
5. Select the asset types to associate with the stakeholder role.
6. Click **Create**.

Creating user role policies in Metadata Command Center

In Metadata Command Center, create and publish access policies for the Technical Owner and Business User user roles. The Technical Owner user role policy grants permissions to the Technical Owners on assets that don't have stakeholders.

1. In Metadata Command Center, open the **Access Control** page.
2. On the **Access Control** page, click the **Access Policies** tab.
3. Click the Action menu icon next to the Governance Owner access policy, and then click **Clone**.
4. Enter a name and description for the new policy.
5. In the **User Role** field, select the **Technical Owner** user role.
6. Go to the **Rules** tab and grant the following permissions:
   - Read, update, and manage access on technical asset types.
   - Read permission on the published Glossary assets and Data Quality Rules. Glossary assets include the Domain, Subdomain, Business Term, and Metric.
   - Read permission on Data Classification, Profiling, Code, and Data attributes.
7. Click **Save**.
8. On the **Access Policies** tab, click the Action menu icon next to the Governance User access policy, and then click **Clone**.
9. Enter a name and description for the new policy.
10. In the **User Role** field, select the **Business User** user role.
11. Go to the **Rules** tab and grant the following permissions:
    - Read permission on the published Glossary assets and Data Quality Rules. Glossary assets include the Domain, Subdomain, Business Term, and Metric.
    - Read permission on Data Classification, Profiling, Code, and Data attributes.
12. Publish and enable the access policies.

Creating stakeholder role policies in Metadata Command Center

In Metadata Command Center, create and publish a stakeholder role policy for the Technical Owner stakeholder role.

1. In Metadata Command Center, open the **Access Control** page.
2. On the **Access Control** page, select the **Access Policies** tab.
3. Click **Add**, and then select **Stakeholder Role Policy**.
4. Enter a name and description for the new policy.
5. In the **Selected Role** field, select **Stakeholder**.
6. In the **Stakeholder Role** field, select the stakeholder role that you created for the Technical Owner user role.
7. Go to the **Rules** tab.

   Grant the following permissions:
   - Read, update, and manage access on technical asset types.
   - Read permission on the published Glossary assets and Data Quality Rules. Glossary assets include the Domain, Subdomain, Business Term, and Metric.

- Read permission on Data Classification, Profiling, Code, and Data attributes.

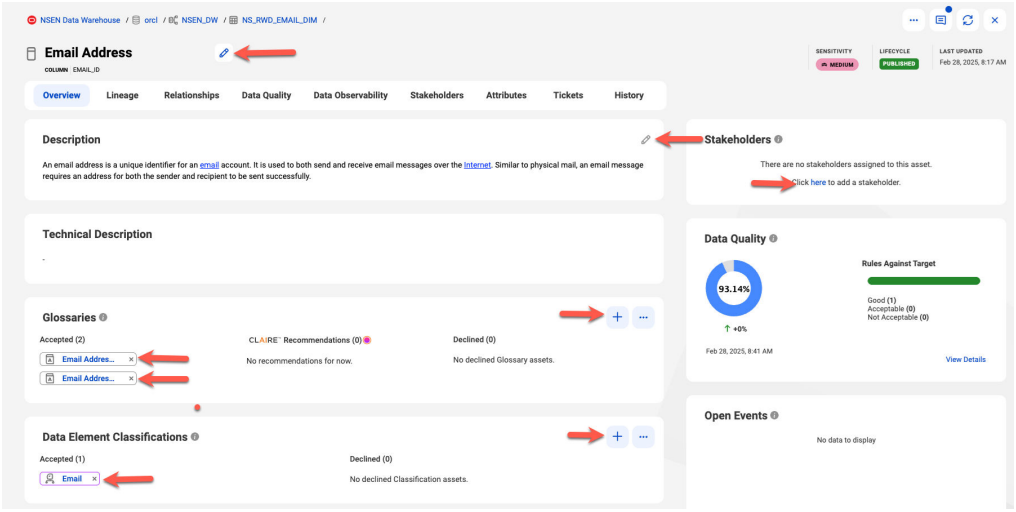
8. Click **Save**.
9. Publish and enable the access policy.

Result

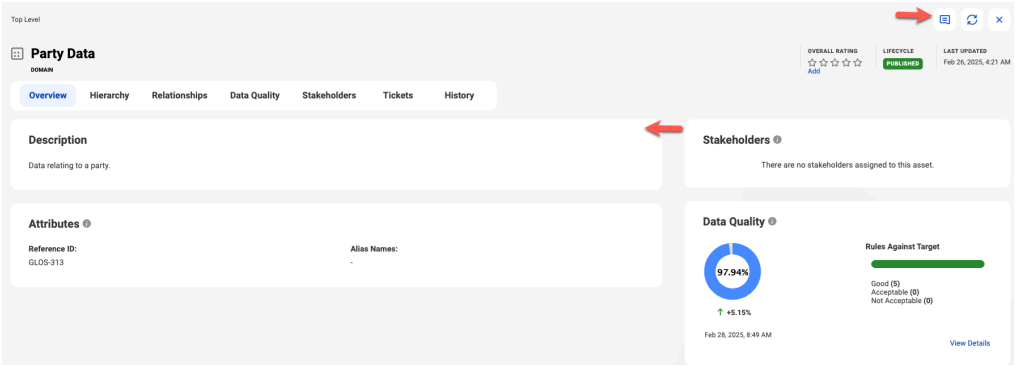
After the access policy takes effect, you can verify that it restricts access to the data.

To verify that the access policy restricts access to the data, perform the following steps:

1. Log in to Data Governance and Catalog as a user with the Technical Owner role.
2. Search for all assets using an asterisk and filter the search results to view only technical assets. You can edit technical assets.



3. Search for all assets using an asterisk and filter the search results to view only business assets. You can view published business assets, but can't edit them, and you can't see business assets in the draft state.



4. Log in as a user with the Business User role.

5. Search for all assets using an asterisk and filter the search results to view only business assets. You can't view technical assets such as catalog sources.
   You can view published business assets, but can't edit them, and you can't see business assets in the draft state.

CHAPTER 8

Example: Restrict access to sensitive data using asset groups

CloudNexus is a global cloud-based software company and a leading provider of products that simplify customer relationship management. CloudNexus uses Data Marketplace to provide its employees with access to timely and trusted data so that they can make faster and better-informed business decisions.

Problem statement

CloudNexus uses Data Marketplace to find customer purchase history and loyalty data to create targeted campaigns and improve sales strategy. CloudNexus is in the process of acquiring DataCrest Technologies, a cloud-based data management company, and wishes to create data collections in Data Marketplace related to the acquisition.

Although CloudNexus believes in democratizing data for all its employees, it wants to restrict access to sensitive data. CloudNexus wants to ensure that only the leadership team and the individuals facilitating the acquisition can access the related information. Non-essential personnel remain unaware of the acquisition.

Solution

CloudNexus can use asset groups in access policies to manage the visibility of the acquisition data. CloudNexus can group these data collections in a separate category that only approved users can access.

Solution summary

CloudNexus can use metadata access control to restrict access to sensitive data collections. To do so, perform the following steps:

1. In Administrator, define a user group called M&A Team and assign this user group only to users who require access to the acquisition data.
2. In Metadata Command Center, create an asset group named M&A People.
3. In Metadata Command Center, create a user group-based access policy for the M&A Team user group with a rule granting read permission on assets within the M&A People asset group.

4. In Data Marketplace, create a dedicated category called M&A Data where you can add related data collections that contain information pertinent to CloudNexus' acquisition of DataCrest Technologies. Assign the M&A People asset group to the M&A Data category.

Creating a user group in Administrator

As an organization administrator, create a user group named M&A Team in Administrator, and add users who are members of the leadership team, individuals essential to facilitating the acquisition, and any other personnel that the leadership team authorizes to access the data.

1. In Administrator, select **User Groups**.
2. Click **Add Group**.
3. Enter the group name as `M&A Team`.

   Optionally, add a description to the group.
4. Assign users to the group.

   To assign a user to the group, on the **Members** tab, click **Manage Users** and select the user from the list. The list of available users doesn't include SAML users because you can't assign SAML users to a group.

   You can also assign a user to a group when you create or edit a user.
5. Click **Save**.

Creating an asset group in Metadata Command Center

In Metadata Command Center, create and publish an asset group named M&A People that only users added to the M&A Team user group in Administrator can access. Use the M&A People asset group when you define an access policy that controls the visibility of the acquisition data in Data Marketplace.

To create an asset group, verify that your user role has the **View Asset Groups** and **Manage Asset Groups** privileges enabled in Administrator.

1. In Metadata Command Center, open the **Customize** page.
2. On the **Customize** page, click the **Asset Groups** tab.
3. On the **Asset Groups** tab, click the **Add** icon.

   Alternatively, in the navigation panel, click **New** > **Customization** > **Asset Group** > **Create**.
4. On the **New Asset Group** page, configure the properties of the asset group.

   The following table describes the properties that you can configure for an asset group on the **New Asset Group** page:

Property	Description
Name	Enter `M&A People` as the name of the asset group.
Description	Optional. Enter a description for the asset group.
Parent	Optional. Select the parent asset group with which you want to associate the asset group. The parent asset group can be a part of a hierarchy.

5. Click **Save**.
6. To publish the asset group, click **Publish**.

Creating an access policy in Metadata Command Center

In Metadata Command Center, create an access policy for the M&A Team user group with a rule granting read permission on assets within the M&A People asset group.

To create an access policy, verify that your user role has the **View Access Control** and **Manage Access Control** privileges enabled in Administrator.

1. In Metadata Command Center, open the **Access Control** page.
2. On the **Access Control** page, click the **Access Policies** tab.
3. Click the **Add** icon, and then select the type of access policy that you want to create.

   Alternatively, in the navigation panel, click **New** > **Access Control**, select the type of access policy, and then click **Create**.
4. On the **Overview** tab of the **New Access Policy** page, configure the properties of the user group policy.

   The following table describes the properties that you can configure when you define a user group policy on the **New Access Policy** > **Overview** tab:

Property	Description
Name	Enter a name for the access policy.
Description	Optional. Enter a description for the access policy.
Selected Group	Select whether you want the user group policy to apply to a specific user group or to all users. You can select from the following options: - To apply the access policy to a specific user group, select **Single User Group**. - To apply the access policy to all users, select **All Users**. Select **Single User Group**.
User Group	Select the **M&A Team** user group.

5. Click **Next**.
6. On the **New Access Policy** > **Rules** tab, click the **Add** icon.
7. Click **Add** > **Asset Type** to add a condition to the rule.
8. On the **Asset Groups** branch, click **Add New**.
9. In the **Select Asset Groups** dialog box, select the M&A People asset group and click **OK**.
10. Open the **Add Permission** menu and select the **Read**, **Update**, and **Manage Access** permissions.
11. Click **Save**.
12. To publish the policy, click **Publish** to start the publishing job.
13. After you publish the policy, open the **Access Control** > **Access Policies** tab.
14. Click the Action menu icon next to the access policy that you created, and click **Enable**.

Creating a category in Data Marketplace

In Data Marketplace, create a category named M&A Data where the personnel that are facilitating CloudNexus' acquisition of DataCrest Technologies can add data collections with information pertinent to the acquisition.

To create a category, verify the following prerequisites:

- Your user profile has one of the following roles:
  - Category Owner
  - Data Marketplace Administrator
- Your user role has the following privileges and permissions:
  - **Access Data Marketplace** privilege is enabled in Administrator.
  - **Create**, **Manage Access**, **Read**, and **Update** permissions for categories are enabled in Metadata Command Center.

1. In Data Marketplace, open the **New** page.
2. On the **New** page, click the **Category** tile to create a new category.
3. On the **New Category** page, configure the category properties.

   The following table describes the properties of a category that you can configure on the **New Category** page:

Property	Description
Reference ID	Enter a reference identifier for the category. If you don't enter a reference identifier, Data Marketplace automatically assigns a unique value to the item. To use your own reference identifier, enter a unique alphabetical, numeric, or alphanumeric value. You can also use special characters when you enter a reference identifier value. Enter a value that doesn't use a prefix that you configure in Metadata Command Center.
Name	Enter `M&A Data` as the name of the category.
Description	Enter a description for the category.
Status	Select a status for the category. The status determines whether the category is discoverable and accessible to the relevant users in Data Marketplace. - To make the category discoverable and usable in Data Marketplace, set the status to `Active`. - To make the category not discoverable and unusable in Data Marketplace, set the status to `Inactive`. To enable the personnel involved in the acquisition to use the category after its creation, set the status of the category to `Active`.
Parent Category	Select a parent category for the category that you want to create. If the category that you want to create isn't a subcategory of another category, you can leave this field empty.
Asset Groups	Select the **M&A People** asset group for the category. When you select the **M&A People** asset group, only users who are members of the M&A Team user group can view the category and its contents. The M&A Data category, its subcategories, and its data collections aren't discoverable to users outside the M&A Team user group.

4. To select the users responsible for the new category and its data, in the **Stakeholders** section, click **Add**.

5. In the **Add Stakeholders** dialog box, select a role, and then select the users or user groups that you want to assign as stakeholders of the category.

   To remove a stakeholder, click the **Delete** icon next to the stakeholder that you want to remove from the **Selected Stakeholders** section.

   Note: When you configure stakeholders for a category, consider the following:

   - If you assign individual users as stakeholders of the category, verify that those users are added to the M&A Team user group in Administrator. Add the users even if only a subset of the M&A Team user group serves as stakeholders of the category.
   - Verify that the users that you want to add as the stakeholders of the category already have the relevant user role in Administrator. For example, if you want to assign a user as a Category Owner of a category, verify that the user already has the Category Owner user role in Administrator. For more information about the user roles that are relevant to Data Marketplace, see the *Introduction and Getting Started* help in Data Marketplace.

     Additionally, verify that the relevant user role is configured as a stakeholder role for categories in Metadata Command Center.
   - If you don't assign a stakeholder to the new category, you can modify the category after its creation only if you are a Data Marketplace Administrator or if your user role has the **Configure and Manage Data Marketplace** privilege enabled in Metadata Command Center.

6. Click **Save**.

Result

After you publish and enable the access policy, users in the M&A Team user group can view the data collections in the M&A Data category. This restriction ensures confidentiality and compliance.

To verify that the data collections in the M&A Data category are discoverable only by users in the M&A Team user group, perform the following steps:

1. Log in to Data Marketplace as a user who isn't a member of the M&A Team user group.
2. On the **Search** page, look for the data collections in the M&A Data category.
   The search results don't show any data collections in the M&A Data category.

   For more information about how you can search for data collections in Data Marketplace, see the *Working With Data Collections* help in Data Marketplace.
3. Log out of Data Marketplace, and then log back in with a user account that is a member of the M&A Team user group.
4. On the **Search** page, look for the data collections in the M&A Data category.
   The search results show the data collections in the M&A Data category.